

【9.10| Economist】Anti-social 反社会的

难度评级：★★★★☆

【考研那些事儿之社论系列】

今日文章脉络：

澳大利亚禁令效果不佳，青少年仍能绕过限制继续使用社交媒体

(Para. 1)



澳大利亚禁令引发他国效仿，成年人支持限制青少年使用社交媒体

(Para. 2)



澳大利亚禁令收效甚微，青少年仍大量使用原有社交平台 (Para. 3)



澳大利亚青少年钻年龄验证系统的空子，绕过社交媒体禁令 (Para.4)



科技公司执行不力，澳大利亚政府拟强化监管并加大处罚力度

(Para.5)



技术局限导致澳大利亚社交媒体禁令难以有效执行 (Para. 6)



多国倾向要求实名身份验证，马来西亚认为其准确性高于澳大利亚的

年龄验证 (Para. 7)



马来西亚年龄验证进展不顺，平台担忧个人信息的安全风险

(Para. 8)



各国探索替代方案，避免一刀切并推动平台承担安全责任 (Para. 9)



澳大利亚年轻人认为自己具备网络安全意识，不应被一刀切限制。

(Para. 10)

Social-media curbs for kids are not working in Asia 亚洲针对儿童使用社交媒体的限制措施并不奏效。

【 学习流程：第一遍请先看原文自己精读，第二遍对照着本精读文档进行理解。文章标注的单词为重点单词，只提供相关注释，想要详细释义麻烦同学查一下词典哦！另外文章底色为灰色的句子为今天的翻译作业，今日文档中的句子分析模块会提供答案，同学们请先思考再看句子分析~ 】

【Para.1】

It seemed A parent's dream. To manage the time her 14-year-old son spent online, Harini Naidu had tried various **tactics**: from restricting Wi-Fi access to turning the internet off at night. So she was excited when Australia became the first country in the world to ban social-media

accounts for under-16s. But the rules, imposed in December, “literally did nothing”. Her son lost his YouTube account, but can still watch videos without logging in. Ms Naidu’s daughter Ishana was 15, but has kept her accounts on X, Instagram, Snapchat and TikTok. Ishana says: “It’s so **underwhelming** that people have forgotten there’s a **ban**.” They do not even have to hide behind virtual private networks.

- **curb v.** /kɜː b/ To control or limit something, especially something undesirable; the edge of a street where the pavement meets the road. 抑制；控制；路缘【考研大纲词汇】
- **tactic n.** /'tæktɪk/ A particular method or plan used to achieve something, especially in a difficult situation. 策略；战术；手段【考研大纲词汇】

The company changed its marketing tactics to attract younger customers. 这家公司改变了营销策略，以吸引更多年轻的顾客。

- **underwhelming a.** /,ʌndə'welmiŋ/ Not as impressive, exciting, or successful as expected. 不如预期的；令人失望的；平淡无奇的【非考研大纲词汇】

The results of the new policy were somewhat underwhelming. 这项新政策的效果有些令人失望。

- **ban** n. /v. /bæn/ An official rule that prevents something from being done or used; to officially prohibit something. 禁令；禁止；取缔；禁止某事【考研英语大纲词汇】

The government has imposed a ban on smoking in public places. 政府已实施公共场所禁烟令。

这本来似乎是每个家长梦寐以求的结果。为了控制 14 岁儿子上网的时间，哈里尼·奈杜尝试过各种办法：从限制 Wi-Fi 接入，到晚上直接断网。因此，当澳大利亚成为全球第一个禁止 16 岁以下未成年人注册社交媒体账号的国家时，她十分兴奋。然而，这项于去年 12 月实施的规定“简直什么作用都没起”。她的儿子失去了 YouTube 账号，却依然可以不登录就观看视频。奈杜女士的女儿伊莎娜当时 15 岁，但她在 X、Instagram、Snapchat 和 TikTok 上的账号都保住了。伊莎娜说：“效果实在太差了，差到人们都已经忘了还有这么一项禁令。”他们甚至都不需要借助虚拟私人网络（VPN）来掩人耳目。

【Para.2】

The experiences of teens like Ishana matter to other countries, too. Since Australia brought in its curbs, dozens have done the same, or are considering it. On August 24th New Zealand announced a planned ban.

Policymakers worry that social media cause various harms to the young. They also know that bans are popular with adults. Many cheered on August 26th when Meta agreed to change its products for under-18s in most American states, including a two-hours-per-day limit on their **scrolling**, after settling a **lawsuit alleging** its platforms harm **youngsters**.

- **policymaker** n. /'pɒləsi , meɪkə(r)/ A person who is responsible for making or changing government policies. 政策制定者；决策者【考研大纲词汇】

Policymakers must consider the long-term effects of the new policy. 政策制定者必须考虑这项新政策的长期影响。

- **Scrol** v. /n. /skrəʊl/ To move text or images up or down on a screen; the act of moving through content on a screen. 滚动；滚屏；浏览
- **lawsuit** n. /'lɔ: su: t/ A legal case in which a person or organization seeks a decision from a court. 诉讼；官司【考研大纲词汇】

The company is facing a lawsuit over the safety of its products. 这家公司正因其产品的安全问题面临诉讼。

- **allege** v. /ə 'ledʒ/ To say that someone has done something wrong or illegal without necessarily having

proof. 声称；指控；宣称【考研大纲词汇】

- **youngster n.** /'jʌŋstə(r)/ A young person, especially a child or teenager. 年轻人；少年；儿童

像伊莎娜这样的青少年的经历，对其他国家同样具有参考意义。自澳大利亚实施相关限制措施以来，已有数十个国家效仿或者正在考虑这样做。8月24日，新西兰宣布计划实施禁令。政策制定者担心，社交媒体会对年轻人造成各种伤害。他们也知道，禁令很受成年人欢迎。8月26日，当 Meta 同意在美国大多数州调整其面向 18 岁以下人群的产品后，许多成年人对此拍手叫好。调整措施包括将每天的刷屏时间限制在两小时以内。此前，Meta 刚刚就一桩指控其平台伤害未成年人的诉讼达成和解。

【Para.3】

Yet so far, Australia's policy has proved largely ineffective. At first the government was able to tout some successes. Social-media platforms had removed, restricted or deactivated almost 5m accounts in the first month. And it may be too early to **write off** the effectiveness of Australia's new rules. But studies have shown they have so far had minimal impact on usage. One in the British Medical Journal in June found that, three months after restrictions were introduced, 85% of under-16s said they still used banned platforms. Twelve- and 13-year-olds spent the same amount of time on social media as before the ban. Worries

that children **migrate** to **alternative** platforms, with lower safety standards, were mostly unfounded—but largely because so many remain on existing ones.

- **write off** *phrase* To decide that someone or something is unlikely to succeed or be useful, or to accept that something is lost or cannot be recovered. 认为.....无用; 认为.....不会成功
- **migrate** v. /maɪˈɡreɪt/ To move from one place to another, especially to live or work there; to move from one system or environment to another. 迁移; 移居; 迁徙【考研大纲词汇】

Many people migrate to cities in search of better job opportunities. 许多人为了寻找更好的工作机会而迁往城市。

- **alternative** a. /ɔːlˈtɜːnətɪv/ Something that can be used or done instead of another thing; different from the usual or traditional choice. 替代方案; 可供选择的事物; 替代的【考研大纲词汇】

Renewable energy provides an alternative to traditional sources of energy. 可再生能源为传统能源提供了一种替代方案。

然而，到目前为止，澳大利亚的这项政策基本上收效甚微。起

初，政府还能够拿出一些成果来宣传。实施禁令后的第一个月，社交媒体平台就删除、限制使用或停用了近 500 万个账号。况且，现在断言澳大利亚新规没有效果或许还为时过早。但研究表明，到目前为止，这些规定对社交媒体使用情况的影响微乎其微。

《英国医学杂志》6 月发表的一项研究发现，在限制措施实施三个月后，85% 的 16 岁以下青少年表示，他们仍在使用被禁的社交媒体平台。12 岁和 13 岁的孩子花在社交媒体上的时间与禁令实施前一样多。人们原本担心孩子会选择安全标准更低的其他媒体平台，但事实证明这种担忧大多没有成为现实——不过，这主要是因为许多的孩子仍然选择原有平台。

【Para.4】

Young Aussies are keen to stay online. Some spy a challenge, says Ishana, as under-16s “want to use social media more because it’s banned”. The young “know how to **outsmart** the system”, she explains, including by creating **joint** accounts with friends, which she thinks **confuses** age-checking systems. Yet she says several accounts with her real date of birth were not removed. Many under-16s have made new accounts using a fake age. Others have entered their parents’ or **siblings’** details.

- **outsmart** v. /ˌaʊtˈsmɑːt/ To gain an advantage over someone by using greater intelligence or better strategies. 智胜；比.....更聪明；智取

The player managed to outsmart his opponent with a clever strategy. 这名选手凭借巧妙的策略智胜了对手。

- **joint** a. /dʒɔɪnt/ A place where two things are connected; shared or done by two or more people or groups. 共同的【考研大纲词汇】
- **confuse** v. /kən'fju: z/ To make someone unable to understand something clearly; to mistake one person or thing for another. 使困惑；使混淆；把.....弄错【考研大纲词汇】
- **sibling** n. /'sɪblɪŋ/ A brother or sister. 兄弟；姐妹；兄弟姐妹

Children often learn how to share and cooperate with their siblings. 孩子们常常从与兄弟姐妹相处中学会分享与合作。

澳大利亚的年轻人仍然很想继续上网。伊莎娜说，一些未成年人甚至把这当成了一种挑战，因为 16 岁以下的孩子“反而因为社交媒体被禁止使用而更想用”。她解释说，年轻人“知道怎么钻系统的空子”，比如和朋友创建共同账号，她认为这种做法会让年龄验证系统难以判断。不过，她说，有几个使用真实出生日期注册的账号却没有被删除。许多 16 岁以下的孩子用虚假的年龄信息创建了新账号。还有一些人则填写了父母或兄弟姐妹的信

息。

【Para.5】

Some blame tech firms for not enforcing the rules. KJR, a software-testing company, recently opened 50 social-media accounts in Australia claiming the user to be 16. It said only one site did any **verification** and all 50 accounts remained active. The government is trying to beef up its rules, including by doubling fines on offending firms to A\$99m (\$71m). It also wants to give Australia's eSafety **Commissioner** power to make social-media firms hand over internal-usage data.

- **verification n.** /ˌverɪfɪˈkeɪʃn/ The process of checking that something is true, accurate, or genuine. 核实；验证；确认【考研大纲词汇】

The information requires careful verification before it is published. 这些信息在发布前需要仔细核实。

- **commissioner n.** /kəˈmɪʃənə(r)/ An official who is responsible for a particular area or department, especially in government or an organization. 专员；委员；行政长官

一些人将责任归咎于科技公司没有落实这些规定。软件测试公司 KJR 最近在澳大利亚开设了 50 个社交媒体账号，并声称这

些账号的用户年龄均为 16 岁。该公司表示，只有一个网站进行了身份验证，而这 50 个账号全部仍处于正常使用状态。澳大利亚政府正试图进一步强化相关规定，其中包括将违规企业的罚款金额提高一倍，增至 9900 万澳元（约合 7100 万美元）。政府还希望赋予澳大利亚电子安全专员更大的权力，要求社交媒体公司提供其平台的内部使用数据。

【Para.6】

Others blame the policy's **ineffectiveness** so far partly on the technology meant to enforce it. Firms are using various tools, including AI, to analyse posts and scan faces. But facial-age estimation software is not very accurate in distinguishing between, say, a 15- and 16-year-old. Lucina, a 15-year-old from the state of Victoria, says her face was **scanned** on Snapchat and she was told she looked 18. "The policy hasn't been tested because it's been technically impossible to enforce," says Tama Leaver of Curtin University in Perth.

- **ineffectiveness** n. / ,ɪnɪ'fektɪvənəs/ The quality of not producing the intended result or effect. 无效; 不起作用; 效果不佳

The ineffectiveness of the policy has raised concerns among policymakers. 这项政策的无效引发了政策制定者的担忧。

- **scan v. /n. /skæn/** To look at something quickly and carefully in order to find particular information; a quick examination of something. 扫描；浏览；快速查看；扫描检查【考研大纲词汇】

She scanned the report to find the information she needed. 她快速浏览了报告，以找到所需的信息。

还有一些人认为，这项政策之所以迄今收效甚微，部分原因在于用于执行该政策的技术本身存在局限。社交媒体公司正在使用各种工具，包括人工智能，来分析帖子内容和扫描人脸。但用于估算年龄的面部识别软件，在区分比如 15 岁和 16 岁的用户时，并不十分准确。来自维多利亚州的 15 岁女孩露西娜说，Snapchat 曾扫描过她的脸，随后却告诉她，她看起来已经 18 岁了。珀斯科廷大学的塔马·利弗说：“这项政策实际上并没有经过真正的检验，因为从技术层面来看，它根本无法得到有效执行。”

【Para.7】

Mr Leaver thinks other countries planning similar laws are concluding that the “only way to do this is to require people’s real **IDs**”—ie, an official digital or physical identity card—when they sign up to social media. Malaysia, one of just a few other countries where Australian-style restrictions are in force, has opted for this method. L.S.

Leonard, the chief legal counsel of Malaysia's Communications and Multimedia Commission, the regulator, says that its assessment indicated that this would be “much more accurate” than the age-assurance approach used in Australia.

- **ID n.** /,aɪ'di/ / An identification document or number used to prove who someone is. 身份证明；身份证件；身份识别号码

You may be asked to show your ID when entering the building. 进入大楼时，你可能会被要求出示身份证件。

利弗先生认为，其他正在计划制定类似法律的国家正在得出这样的结论：“要做到这一点，唯一的办法就是要求人们提供真实的身份证明”——也就是说，用户注册社交媒体账号时必须提供官方的数字或实体身份证件。马来西亚是少数几个已经实施类似澳大利亚限制措施的国家之一，该国选择了这种做法。马来西亚通信与多媒体委员会这一监管机构的首席法律顾问 L.S. Leonard 表示，该机构的评估结果显示，与澳大利亚采用的年龄验证方式相比，这种方法会“准确得多”。

【Para.8】

Yet things are not going to plan in Malaysia either. Mr Leonard says social-media platforms claim to have removed lots of under-age accounts, according to their own guidelines. But nothing has changed for most

users, says Tricia Yeoh of the University of Nottingham's Malaysian branch. Mr Leonard says platforms have asked for time to “make their system **adaptable**” for age **verification**; he expects everything “to be resolved” by January, after which non-compliers may be fined. Ms Yeoh, however, suspects platforms are worried about the risks of storing personal IDs on systems that could be **hacked**, or subject to requests from governments.

- **adaptable** a. /ə 'dæptəbl/ Able to change or adjust easily to different conditions or situations. 适应性强的；能适应的；可调整的【考研大纲词汇】

Young people are often more adaptable to changes in the workplace. 年轻人通常更能适应工作环境中的变化。

- **verification** n. / ,verɪfɪ 'keɪʃn/ The process of checking that something is true, accurate, or genuine. 核实；验证；确认【考研大纲词汇】

The information requires careful verification before it is published. 这些信息在发布前需要仔细核实。

- **Hack** v. /n. /hæk/ To gain unauthorized access to a computer or system; an act of gaining such access. 入侵；非法侵入；黑客攻击；窍门【考研大纲词汇】

Hackers attempted to hack into the company's computer system. 黑客试图侵入该公司的计算机系统。

然而，马来西亚的情况同样没有按计划发展。Leonard 先生表示，根据社交媒体平台自己的规定，这些平台声称已经删除了大量未达到规定年龄的账号。但诺丁汉大学马来西亚分校的 Tricia Yeoh 表示，对大多数用户来说，实际上什么都没有改变。Leonard 先生说，各平台要求给予它们一些时间，以便“让系统适应”年龄验证；他预计这些问题将在明年 1 月前“得到解决”，届时仍不遵守规定的平台可能会被罚款。不过，Yeoh 女士怀疑，各平台真正担心的是：如果把个人身份证明信息存储在可能遭到黑客入侵的系统中，或者这些信息可能被政府要求调取，就会带来相应的风险。

【Para.9】

Some oppose blunt social-media bans like Australia's because they think they let platforms get away with not making their sites safe. Ways to incentivise firms to do so are being contemplated. Canada plans to ban platforms from allowing under-16s to have social-media accounts, but only until these apps meet a set of safety criteria. And there are hopes that Meta, after introducing limits for teens in most American states, will roll the same features out elsewhere, and that other social-media firms

will **follow suit**.

- **blunt** a. /blʌnt/ Not sharp or pointed; expressed in a direct way without trying to be polite; to make something less sharp or effective.直率的; 直截了当的【考研大纲词汇】

She was blunt about the problems with the current system. 她直截了当地指出了现行制度存在的问题。

- **incentivise** v. /ɪn'sentɪvaɪz/ To encourage someone to do something by offering them a reward or advantage. 激励; 鼓励; 刺激【非考研大纲词汇】

The government introduced tax breaks to incentivise companies to invest in clean energy. 政府推出税收优惠, 以激励企业投资清洁能源。

- **contemplate** v. /'kɒntəmpleɪt/ To think carefully about something for a long time before making a decision. 仔细考虑; 深思; 考虑【考研大纲词汇】

The government is contemplating new measures to reduce carbon emissions. 政府正在考虑采取新的措施来减少碳排放。

- **follow suit** *phrase* To do the same thing as someone else, especially by following their example. 仿效; 照着

做；跟随.....的做法

Several other companies followed suit and introduced similar policies. 其他几家公司也纷纷效仿，出台了类似的政策。

一些人反对像澳大利亚这样“一刀切”的社交媒体禁令，因为他们认为这会反而让平台得以逃避责任，不去提升平台的安全性。目前，人们正在考虑通过各种方式激励企业采取这样的措施。加拿大计划禁止社交媒体平台允许 16 岁以下未成年人注册账号，但只有在这些应用达到一套规定的安全标准之前才会如此。与此同时，人们希望 Meta 在美国大多数州针对青少年推出相关限制措施后，也能将同样的功能推广到其他地区，并希望其他社交媒体公司也能纷纷效仿。

【Para.10】

Young Australians think they deserve more credit: Ms Naidu's 14-year-old son says many teenagers already “know how to be safe online”. He stays off X, for example, because it is “very **unfiltered**”. He prefers Reddit, which is “less **unhinged**”.

- **unfiltered** a. /ʌn 'fɪltəd/ Not controlled, edited, or changed to remove unwanted or inappropriate content; expressed openly and directly. 未经过滤的；未经审查的；

The interview gave viewers an unfiltered look at the athlete's life. 这次采访让观众直接了解了这名运动员的生活。

- **unhinged** a. /ʌn 'hɪndʒd/ Behaving in an extremely strange, uncontrolled, or unreasonable way. 失控的；不理智的

澳大利亚的年轻人认为，他们应该得到更多认可。杜女士14岁的儿子说，许多青少年已经“知道如何安全地使用互联网”。比如，他不会使用 X，因为那里“未经审查的内容太多”。相比之下，他更喜欢 Reddit，因为那里“没那么失控”。

September 5TH-11TH | Asia

关注微信公众号【经济学人考研英语】，加入训练营，按照群公告学习流程精读，在[资料禁言群]中查看全文翻译，并在打卡圈子里分享你的学习心得吧~

➤ 今日翻译作业

(Para.3) Worries that children migrate to alternative platforms, with lower safety standards, were mostly unfounded—but largely because so many remain on existing ones.(下一页提供句子分析)

➤ 今日句子分析

Para.3

Worries that children migrate to alternative platforms, with lower safety standards, were mostly unfounded—but largely because so many remain on existing ones.

人们原本担心孩子会选择安全标准更低的其他媒体平台，但事实证明这种担忧大多没有成为现实——不过，这主要是因为许多的孩子仍然选择原有平台。

Worries that children migrate to alternative platforms,
 with lower safety standards, were mostly unfounded—but
 largely because so many remain on existing ones.

主语 修饰主语的同位语从句
 介词短语 系动词 副词 表语
 连词 主语 1 谓语 1 宾语

整体结构：

主句 + that 引导的同位语从句 + with 介词短语 + but
 because 原因结构

1. 先找主干：Worries were mostly unfounded.

这些担忧大多是没有根据的。

Worries：主语

were：系动词

mostly unfounded: 表语

所以最核心的意思：这些担忧大多没有成为现实。

2. that 引导的同位语从句，具体解释 worries (担忧) 的内容。

worries = the worries that children migrate...

这里的 that 不能理解成“那些/那个”，而是：担心孩子会转向其他平台。类似：the fact that he lied 他撒谎这一事实/the worry that prices will rise 担心价格会上涨

所以：Worries that children migrate to alternative platforms= 担心孩子会转向其他平台的忧虑。

3. with + 名词 + 名词 在这里是一个伴随/附加说明的介词短语。with：具有.....lower safety standards：更低的安全标准
修饰前面的：alternative platforms。即：alternative platforms with lower safety standards 安全标准更低的其他平台。

4. 破折号后面的 but largely because...这是全句最值得注意的地方：—but largely because so many remain on existing ones。可以先把它还原成完整句：But the worries were mostly unfounded largely because so many children remain on existing platforms. 这里实际上是对前面的 were mostly unfounded 进行原因解释。

➤ 写作积累

1. (Para.4)Young Aussies **are keen to** stay online.

be keen to do sth.非常想做某事；渴望做某事；热衷于做某事

【考研大纲词汇】。之前文章中的：Young Aussies are keen to stay online. 这里的 **keen to** 不是简单的“喜欢”，而是很想做某事 / 很愿意做某事。该词汇有以下近义词表达：

- ◆ **be eager to do sth:** 渴望做某事。表示非常想做某事，并且带有强烈的期待或热情。语气通常比 **be keen to** 更强。Young people are eager to explore new technologies 年轻人渴望探索新技术。区别：eager 强调“迫切、热切地期待”，而 **keen** 更偏向“很有兴趣、很愿意”。
- ◆ **be willing to do sth:** 愿意做某事。强调的是愿意、乐意去做，不一定表示“非常想做”。因此感情色彩比 **keen to** 弱。The company is willing to invest more money in research.
- ◆ **be enthusiastic about doing sth:** 强调对某件事情充满热情和兴趣，比 **keen to** 更突出“热情”。Many students are enthusiastic about learning foreign languages. 许多学生热衷于学习外语。这家公司愿意在研究方面投入更多资金。区别：
keen to → 很想做 / **willing to** → 愿意做
- ◆ **be interested in doing sth:** 表示有兴趣，但程度通常比 **keen to** 弱。She is interested in working in the technology

industry. 她对在科技行业工作感兴趣。语气梯度可以大致理解为：

be interested in → 感兴趣

be keen to → 很想做

be eager to → 渴望做

2. (Para.9)Some oppose blunt social - media bans like Australia' s because they think they let platforms **get away with** not making their sites safe.

get away with : (做错事或违法后) 逃脱惩罚; 逃避责任; 蒙混过关。Some companies think they can get away with ignoring safety regulations. 一些公司认为, 即使无视安全规定, 也能逃脱惩罚。核心用法: get away with + 名词 / doing sth.